

Bayer AG (BAYGn.DE): Key takeaways from the Kerendia deep-dive event

We hosted Bayer for a Kerendia deep-dive event on July 15 with Bernardo Kanahuati – Kerendia Product Team Lead from Bayer, Dr. Meike Brinker – Kerendia Development Lead from Bayer, and Dr. Vlado Perkovic – Provost and Scientia Professor at the University of New South Wales (*no replay available*).

Our key takeaways are: **1)** Bayer sees a multi-blockbuster opportunity across CKD and Heart Failure, with 800m+ patients eligible for therapy, with a strong body of evidence and positive guidelines supporting Kerendia as part of the standard of care; **2)** The KOL is optimistic about Kerendia's rapid uptake driven by non-diabetic CKD data which support drug use across various CKD subtypes and in combination of SGLT2s; **3)** The KOL underscored Kerendia's competitive advantage over other CKD drugs including Baxfendy (in clinical development) and Vanrafia, while noting combination potential with APRIL inhibitors; **4)** Bayer management expressed confidence in a positive outcome of the reduced ejection fraction (HFrEF) trial, noting potential to update peak sales guidance for Kerendia, although data will now likely be disclosed in 2027.

An emerging question on Kerendia is potential future competition from Baxfendy/ the Aldosterone Synthetase Inhibitor class – in our view, given the timing of clinical trials, Baxfendy will only have a similar data package to Kerendia c.2 years prior to Kerendia patent expiry, and given the time required for CV launches to accelerate, we see limited impact on Kerendia peak sales – where we sit ahead of Visible Alpha Consensus at €4.5bn vs. c.€3bn. Therefore, we believe Kerendia remains a key source of upside for the Bayer Pharma business, with high gross margins and outsized earnings upside relative to consensus estimates.

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Detailed takeaways

- **Commercial opportunity could be significant, with 800m+ patients eligible for Kerendia treatment across heart failure and CKD.** From an unmet need/ addressable population perspective, Bayer highlighted that in the past 12 months around 2.5m patients have been treated with Kerendia. In CKD, Kerendia is approved in 102 countries and has launched in 93 countries, while in heart failure, Kerendia has been approved in 46 countries and launched in 14 markets - with blockbuster potential in each area.
 - *Our view;* Applying the current average price per patient over the past 12 months (2.5m patients vs. c.€1bn revenue), suggests around 9-10m patients being treated with Kerendia globally at peak in 2032 of €4.5bn, which given the current trajectory, and 6.5 years, is very achievable. Especially, with the non-diabetic CKD and heart failure with reduced ejection fraction populations still to contribute to the peak sales potential.
- **The KOL is optimistic about Kerendia's rapid uptake driven by non-diabetic CKD data which support drug use across various CKD subtypes and in combination with SGLT2s.** This data supports the drug's utility across diverse CKD subtypes and in combination with SGLT2 inhibitors (as highlighted in the CONFIDENCE trial), which have become standard-of-care. The KOL also noted that physicians understand the underlying reasons for the acute eGFR decline observed in the FIND-CKD trial, and therefore, do not anticipate it will hinder clinical adoption. In terms of overcoming clinical inertia in the community, the KOL pointed towards the SGLT-2 class, which saw stronger uptake in CKD when a CV benefit was seen in the non-diabetic setting, which could benefit Kerendia uptake following the FIND-CKD data.
- **The KOL underscored Kerendia's competitive advantage over other CKD drugs including Baxfendy (in clinical development) and Vanrafia, while noting combination potential with APRIL inhibitors.** For IgAN patients, the KOL noted a two-pronged treatment approach: addressing IgAN-specific drivers (e.g., inhibiting toxic IgA synthesis) and managing generic responses (e.g., reducing proteinuria and blood pressure). This strategy suggests a potential for Kerendia to be combined with APRIL inhibitors. Regarding competition from Vanrafia, KOLs noted Kerendia's comparable efficacy and highlighted the benefit of physician familiarity, given Kerendia demonstrated efficacy across various CKD subtypes, including IgAN. With respect to Baxfendy, which is currently in Phase 3 trials with results anticipated in 2028/2029, the KOL acknowledged that a combination with Kerendia is unlikely. Nevertheless, he pointed to Kerendia's first-mover advantage as a significant factor supporting its clinical utility, while ultimately stressing that future clinical trial data will be the key determinant.
 - *Our view;* We agree that optically, based on UACR/UPCR data, Vanrafia and Kerendia look similar in IgAN (c.35% decline vs. c.39% decline for Kerendia). A key difference will come from cost - the list price of Vanrafia is \$14,291 per month vs. \$1,100 per month for Kerendia, which gives Kerendia a volume advantage with payors/ PBMs in our view. This could be a negative impact on

our Novartis Vanrafia peak sales forecast of \$1.2bn.

- On Baxfendy competition, the overlapping mechanism/ safety profiles (hyperkalemia) make combination therapies unlikely. Phase 3 data for Baxfendy + Farxiga in BaxDuo-Arctic (CKD with hypertension) is expected in 2028 with approval by end 2028, and BaxDuo-pacific is anticipated by the end of 2029, with approval by mid-2030 and Prevent-HF is also expected by the end of 2029, with approval by mid-2030. Therefore, it will take at least a further four years before Baxfendy has a similar label to Kerendia, by which time, we will be almost 2 years away from Kerendia generic entry, and Baxfendy will take time to drive physician education and uptake (in line with general CV launches). Therefore, we are not concerned about the near-to-mid term potential competitive threat from Baxfendy.
- **Bayer management expressed confidence in a positive outcome of the reduced ejection fraction (HFrEF) trial, noting potential to update peak sales guidance for Kerendia.** They cited supportive data from Phase 2 studies and subgroup analyses within the Phase 3 FINEARTS-HF trial, which demonstrated consistent benefits in patients with lower ejection fraction values. Additionally, the company's peak sales guidance on Kerendia could be updated at the right time, per management.
 - *Our view;* We continue to believe that the data from the ARTS-HF trial (the original Phase 2 trial in HFrEF patients), combined with FINEARTS-HF provide strong evidence that both FINALITY-HF and CONFIRMATION-HF will both yield positive results. We continue to believe that the heart failure indication, could be one of the key reasons why our forecasts are significantly ahead of Vare Consensus peak sales with GSe peak of €4.5bn vs. consensus of around €3bn.

Valuation and risks

We are Buy rated on Bayer. Our DCF valuation (50% weighting in the PT) is €65 per share which assumes an 8.8% WACC and TV growth rate of 1.5%. Our SOTP-based valuation (50% weighting in the PT) is €60 per share. This leads to our 12-month target price of €62.5.

Key downside risks to our view and price target: (1) Earnings momentum in Crop Science returning to negative territory; (2) Greater-than-anticipated margin impact from Pharma generics holding back divisional earnings development; (3) Negative outcomes and slower resolution across the various litigation processes; (4) Slower-than-anticipated realisation of the cost and operational benefits from the new DSO operating model.

BAYGn.DE	12m Price Target: €62.50	Price: €49.12	Upside: 27.2%
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Buy	GS Forecast
Market cap: €48.3bn / \$55.2bn	Revenue (€ mn) 12/25 45,575.0 12/26E 45,558.5 12/27E 46,878.9 12/28E 48,523.7
Enterprise value: €81.8bn / \$93.6bn	EBIT (€ mn) 8,082.0 7,394.2 8,027.0 8,955.7
3m ADTV: €131.4mn / \$151.8mn	EPS (€) 4.91 4.32 4.61 5.43
Germany	P/E (X) 5.3 11.4 10.7 9.1
Europe Pharma & Life Sciences	EV/EBITDA (ex lease,X) 5.8 8.6 7.9 7.1
M&A Rank: 3	Dividend yield (%) 0.4 2.3 2.4 2.6
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes	FCF yield (%) 13.5 (1.4) 8.3 9.4
	CROCI (%) 1.0 7.8 7.4 7.7
	N debt/EBITDA (ex lease,X) 3.2 3.5 3.2 2.8
	12/25 3/26E 6/26E 9/26E
	EPS (€) 0.62 2.71 0.77 0.44

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 14 Jul 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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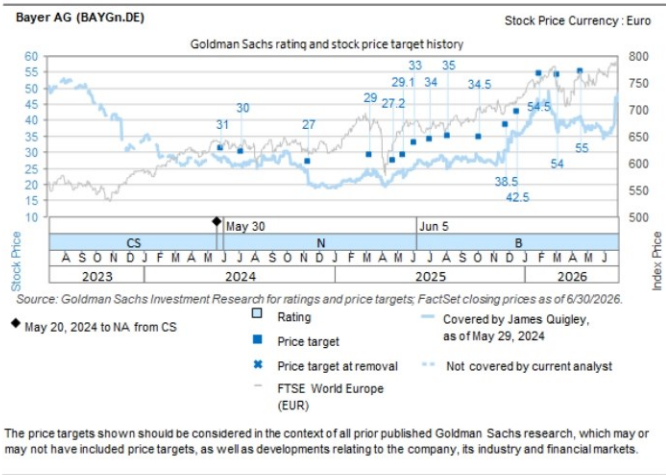
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Target price history table(s)

Bayer AG (BAYGn.DE)

Date of report	Target price (€)	Closing price (€)
06-Jul-26	62.50	51.18
20-Apr-26	55.00	41.36
05-Mar-26	54.00	37.78
30-Jan-26	54.50	44.56
19-Dec-25	42.50	35.88
27-Nov-25	38.50	30.62
07-Oct-25	34.50	27.78
07-Aug-25	35.00	25.37
04-Jul-25	34.00	26.20
05-Jun-25	33.00	26.43
14-May-25	29.10	22.17
25-Apr-25	27.20	22.99
10-Mar-25	29.00	23.56
13-Nov-24	27.00	20.15
08-Jul-24	30.00	26.06
30-May-24	31.00	28.06

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